

MD Kamrul Islam

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Marketing

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Consumer Behavior, Judgment and Decision-Making, Consumer Response to AI, Digital Platforms and Marketplaces

EDUCATION

College of Business, Illinois State University

May 2027 (expected)

Master of Business Administration (STEM), Business Analytics

Current GPA: 4.00 / 4.00

- Completed quantitative coursework spanning Programming for Data Science, Advanced Business Analytics, Advanced Marketing Analytics, and Applied Decision-making Tools.
- Pursuing two concurrent graduate certificates: Data Science (9 credit hours) and Business Analytics (12 credit hours), both expected May 2027.

Institute of Business Administration (IBA), University of Dhaka

Jan. 2018 — Jun. 2022

Bachelor of Business Administration, Marketing & Economics

Final Two-Year GPA: 3.65 / 4.00

- Recognized on the graduation Honors List for national-level achievements in Business case competitions.
- Completed foundational research and quantitative coursework including Research Methods, Econometrics, Business Statistics, Quantitative Analysis, and Consumer Behavior.

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

Conference Proceeding

Islam, M. K., & Jagani, S. (2026). "Saying AI out loud: Cross-category evidence on how AI-signaling keywords shape post-purchase consumer evaluations." Proceedings of the *Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference*. [Accepted]

- Examined how AI-signaling language embedded in e-commerce product listings shapes post-purchase star ratings, using the Amazon Reviews 2023 dataset across 3,869 products in two consumer electronics categories.
- Demonstrated that the effect of AI-signaling language is category-contingent and concentrated in the budget price tier, interpreted through expectation-disconfirmation and signal credibility theories.
- Introduced AI-signaling language as a new dimension of product listing signals within the emerging AI-and-marketing literature.

Working Paper

Islam, M. K., & Jagani, S. "Does AI Language Help or Hurt?" Targeting *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*. [Data collection in progress; target submission October 2026.]

- Extending the archival findings into a four-study program combining controlled online experiments with a parallel archival validation arm.
- Testing the psychological mechanism linking AI claim exposure to post-purchase evaluation, isolating claim credibility and expectation disconfirmation as competing accounts.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Department of Marketing, Illinois State University

Normal, Illinois

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Aug. 2025 — Present

- Support instruction across multiple sections of undergraduate marketing courses, assisting faculty with course preparation, material development, and administrative coordination.
- Grade assignments and examinations against established rubrics, maintaining consistency and confidentiality across large sections.
- Renewed for a second consecutive academic year on the basis of performance and department recommendation.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Peer Evaluation Automation System

Illinois State University

Designer and Developer (for MKT 350)

Spring 2026

- Replaced a manual paper-based peer evaluation process with a fully digital workflow covering student submission, scoring, and faculty review.
- Built a Google Form (dropdown inputs, ten Likert items, 100-point allocation) feeding a spreadsheet that automatically scores responses, flags self-versus-peer discrepancies, and checks submission completeness.
- Created a Looker Studio dashboard that refreshes every 15 minutes for team- and student-level review and documented a reusable semester rollover that reduces setup to roster updates alone.

AutoStock: Blockchain-Based Stock Market Automation

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Co-Author and Team Member, Team Masala Dosa

Sep. 2021

- Diagnosed structural inefficiencies in the Dhaka Stock Exchange, including settlement delays, intermediary fees, information asymmetry, and weak surveillance.
- Proposed a public permissioned blockchain architecture using smart contracts to automate trade execution, cash clearance, and settlement.
- Authored the supporting whitepaper, which earned the Silver Award (second nationally) at Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh 2021 and a Merit Award at the International Blockchain Olympiad.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Flagship

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Senior Marketing Associate

Nov. 2024 — May 2025

- Led product marketing for Horizon, an enterprise tool embedding short-form video into websites and apps, owning its go-to-market launch and website.
- Sustained a 25% click-through rate curating Horizon content on MyGP, Bangladesh's largest super-app.

Ilmiya

Minneapolis, Minnesota (Remote)

Marketing Team Lead

Jun. 2022 — Jan. 2025

- Directed marketing across product, engineering, and customer success for a K-12 LMS platform.
- Onboarded 14 schools in six months and lifted conversion rates 12% via restructured sales workflows.

Prottoy EdTech

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Chief Marketing Officer and Co-Founder

Aug. 2020 — Sep. 2022

- Co-founded Bangladesh's first visual learning mobile app (10,000+ users), leading all marketing and fundraising.
- Raised \$50K in seed funding and ran Mnemomania, a national Memory Olympiad engaging 113,000+ students.

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND HONORS

Merit-Based Conference Presentation Award, College of Business

2026

- Awarded \$1,000 for research travel funding to present accepted paper at the DSI 2026 Annual Conference.

Full Scholarship, TRUE Leadership Conference

2026

- Received a fully funded scholarship to attend the leadership development conference in North Carolina.

Graduate Honors List, Institute of Business Administration, University of Dhaka

2022

- Named on the graduation Honors List for national-level competitive achievement representing the institute.

Award of Merit, International Blockchain Olympiad — Global Final, Dhaka, Bangladesh

2021

Silver Award (Second Nationally), Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh

2021

Award of Merit, International Blockchain Olympiad — Global Final, CityU, Hong Kong

2020

Fifth Place, Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh

2020

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

- President**, Graduate Business Birds, College of Business, Illinois State University 2026-27
- Led strategic planning, networking, events, and budget for the college's graduate business student organization.
- Research Team Member**, Faculty-led Project, Illinois State University 2025-26
- Screened and synthesized peer-reviewed literature on intellectual property instruction to support manuscript development.
- Cultural Secretary**, Bangladesh Student Association, Illinois State University 2025-26
- Organized cultural events for Bangladeshi students, while managing logistics and social media outreach.
- Session Administrator**, DSI Annual Pedagogy Conference Organizing Committee 2026
- Supported live session delivery and technical operations as a member of the conference organizing committee.

RESEARCH SKILLS AND TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Quantitative Methods: Archival data analysis; text-based keyword classification and coding; OLS regression; clustering analysis (hierarchical and partitional); ANOVA; descriptive statistics; data cleaning and preparation.

Programming: R (regression modeling, data manipulation, clustering, ggplot2 visualization); Python (data collection, text analysis, exploratory data analysis).

Analytics and Visualization: Looker Studio; Power BI; Microsoft Excel (advanced); ggplot2; Google Sheets.

AI Tools: Claude and Claude Code; ChatGPT; Google AI Studio; Gemini; Perplexity

Research Tools: Google Workspace (Forms, Sheets, Docs); GitHub; Microsoft Office Suite.

Domain Expertise: Consumer behavior in digital contexts; e-commerce and marketplace dynamics; EdTech platforms and market strategy; brand and product positioning.

Professional Skills: Cross-functional collaboration; team leadership; project management; stakeholder communication; instructional support and mentoring; confidential data handling.

STANDARDIZED TESTS AND LANGUAGES

- GRE General Test (2023):** Total 315 — Quantitative 162, Verbal 153, Analytical Writing 4.5.
- IELTS Academic (2023):** Overall 8.0 — Listening 8.5, Reading 9.0, Writing 7.0, Speaking 7.5.
- Languages:** Bengali (native); English (full professional proficiency).

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Graduate Certificate: Business Analytics**, Illinois State University In progress
- Graduate Certificate: Data Scientist**, Illinois State University In progress
- Google AI Sales Academy**, Sales Academy, Google for Startups 2024

REFERENCES

Sandeep Jagani, PhD, Associate Professor and Assistant Chair, Department of Management
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